Oleksandr Yukhno

AI Transformation · Next-generation PMO · Operational Transformation

Currently in Poland · open to relocation within Europe · remote, hybrid, travel
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SUMMARY

30+ years across electronics, software, project delivery and retail operations. Former CTO at Ciklum and Director of the IT office and the project management office at Silpo, one of Ukraine's largest food retail chains (about 120 → 300 stores, around 40,000 people during my years). Today a partner at FlipManager, an AI-products startup, building AI assistants and an AI-run project office. Interested in projects and roles in AI adoption, operational transformation and building a next-generation PMO, where I own the result.

CORE SKILLS

- AI adoption with governance: multi-vendor review, human decision, data-security readiness
- PMO set-up and portfolio management; training project managers
- Operational transformation and process redesign; labour standards and scheduling
- Planning, budgeting, store P&L, KPI systems (balanced scorecard)
- Restructuring: legal-entity mergers, integration of acquired chains
- IT infrastructure, standards and procedures; working across operations, commerce, finance and IT

EXPERIENCE

Partner (co-founder), AI-products startup · FlipManager — Now

- Two-partner startup building an AI exoskeleton for managers: four products on one base (DPA personal assistant, DBA small-business assistant, DPC corporate assistant, DCC Digital Company Compass).
- Lead the assistants for individuals and small business owners; designing PMO Hub, an AI-run project office with fixed AI roles (product owner, architect, tester, design critic, auditor) and cross-checks by a second AI vendor.
- PMO Hub started as the tool for managing DPA development; DPA and both public Autosound projects were built with it in 2026.

Author · Autosound (own projects, public on GitHub) — 2026

- Method gathered from approaches, documentation, libraries and my own and friends' experience; built with AI's help into a skill that makes the seven-phase process for tuning car audio around a sound processor deterministic while keeping AI flexible at every step; works in Claude, Codex and Antigravity; 14 major and minor releases since June 2026.
- TCC: multilingual desktop app for macOS and Windows on top of the skill; 4,300+ automated tests; AI chat panel; works with different AI models directly or through the OMP tool.
- Results in 2026: five awards for my own car at EMMA and AYA championships, including two first places in qualifying rounds and third at the German EMMA Final; one user's car took first place at the AYA Finale.

Director of the Project Management Office (reporting to the Retail Director) · Silpo — From 2012

- Annual planning and budgeting of store and production headcount, payroll and productivity, driven by format, processes and planned revenue.
- Store P&L: the costs a store manager controls became visible by the 5th of the following month.
- KPI system based on the balanced scorecard, from a single store to the whole chain.
- Restructuring: stores moved between legal entities and acquired chains integrated.
- Expert in a McKinsey working group on operational processes; projects on promotions, pricing, markdowns and assortment; mobile platform for store processes; one annual stocktake instead of monthly ones.
- Built and taught a practical project management course for retail.

Director of the IT Office (reporting to the executive director) · Silpo — 2008–2012

- Standards, checklists and procedures for regional IT teams supporting the stores.

- Store processes described; document flow between stores and offices put in order, with a new records department.
- Labour standards; staff and checkout schedules planned in half-hour slots from customer traffic; queue alerts by SMS.
- More than 20 operating legal entities merged into one.

Regional Manager, Eastern Europe (outstaffed from Ciklum) · Scanvaegt International 2006–2007

- Industrial weighing and processing systems: equipment supply, commissioning and hardware and software roll-outs while large plants were being built, including the MHP slaughter plant in Kaniv.

CTO · Ciklum 2005–2006

- IT infrastructure, standards and procedures, planning and budgeting, presale and hiring support for clients.
- The company grew from about 50 to 250 people while I was there.

Project Manager, then Manager for International Clients · ProFIX 2002–2005

- Management of banking software projects and international client accounts.

Banking software · ProFIX 1999–2002

- Developing and delivering banking systems.

Chief Engineer, Main Settlement Centre · Bank Ukraina 1998–1999

Team Lead and Project Manager, banking automation · Avan 1996–1998

Software Developer (software for banks from 1995) · Escape 1994–1996

EDUCATION

MAUP: Business management 2002–2003
Kharkiv Polytechnic Institute: Computer science, systems programming 1991–1996
Kharkiv Technical School of Radio Electronics: CNC machine tools 1987–1991

TRAINING

IMD Business School: Short executive programmes (in Lausanne and on-site)
Ernst & Young: Decision management: cost, profit, pricing
McKinsey: Trainings during the operations project at Silpo

LANGUAGES

Ukrainian (native), English (working)

ALSO

Built my own house and designed its engineering systems; the house and my apartment run as smart homes on a Raspberry Pi server with Home Assistant, now maintained and developed by AI.

P.S. AI assembled this document from my website, which we also built together: the idea on Wednesday, two days of thinking and a prototype with Codex, then eight hours of work in which Claude wrote the code and Gemini reviewed and translated. The result: a proofread site online for about $40 in tokens. The direction and the check of every line are mine. That is how I would run AI projects in your company.